

Beyond Sedona

ONE-PAGE METHODOLOGY · MIT 1.125 · Research checked 22 September 2026 UTC

Purpose and scope

Help Arizona tourism planners screen seasonal side trips from Sedona. Six selected state parks represent two Sedona-area reference sites and four candidates in Cottonwood, Jerome and Camp Verde. These are attraction comparisons, not measurements of total municipal tourism.

Collection and provenance

Public secondary research was checked on September 22, 2026 (UTC). The dataset contains 144 monthly park observations for 2024–2025, 54 spending entries, three resident-response percentages, six hotel-market observations, and a destination evidence register. The 2024 attendance PDF was downloaded and extracted; 2025 counts were transcribed from the indexed NAU report after its direct download returned 404. Monthly sums match each published annual total; the six 2025 totals also match the university economic study. No personal records were collected.

Sources and definitions

Attendance: Arizona State Parks, compiled by NAU [1–2]. A visit is not a unique person; counts include local users. Spending: University of Arizona [3], 2025 nominal dollars associated with non-local visitors within 50 miles of each park, Tables 35 and 44. Use the published direct totals; category sums may differ slightly through rounding. Resident views: Sedona's weighted 2024 probability-sample survey [4], 551 respondents overall, 20% response rate and reported overall ± 4 percentage-point margin at 95% confidence. Hotel context: City of Sedona / STR [5], August–October 2025, Sedona+ and Village of Oak Creek+ study areas.

Calculations and interpretation

Peak-relative visitation = month visits $\div$ the park's largest monthly count $\times$ 100. Annual share = month visits $\div$ annual visits $\times$ 100. Year-over-year change = $(2025 \text{ total} \div 2024 \text{ total} - 1) \times 100$. Summer means June–August. Rockin' River Ranch's January 2024 zero is marked not yet open and excluded from the comparable five-park change. No weighted opportunity score or spending forecast is used. Proposed pilots combine observed timing with attraction type and documented access.

Limits and next evidence

Two years cannot establish a long-term trend or explain changes. Counts are not adjusted for open days, weather, closures, or events. Spending areas overlap and do not establish town receipts or campaign impact. Survey nonresponse and coverage bias remain; Sedona views do not represent receiving communities. Hotel reporting samples and geography differ, and a closure affected supply. Neighboring-town room availability, carrying capacity, travel times, and resident consent are unverified. A pilot should establish these conditions and measure whether side trips replace time in Sedona or extend a trip.

Source links

1. [NAU attendance 2024](#)
2. [NAU attendance 2025](#)
3. [University of Arizona park economics, 2025](#)
4. [Sedona National Community Survey, 2024](#)
5. [Sedona lodging report, October 2025](#)